

STAGE FOURTEEN • PROJECT MANAGEMENT

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • FAQ

Stage Fourteen • Project Management

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Fourteen, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if my real project is too small or informal to feel like a genuine 'project'?

A: Size and formality don't matter here — the discipline is the same whether it's a multi-million dollar initiative or planning a family trip. Pick whatever real project you have and apply the same rigor.

Q2. What if I don't have a real stakeholder to interview for the requirements-gathering exercise (FIRST R4)?

A: Use a real past request you received instead, and reconstruct in hindsight what the genuine underlying need likely was. The skill being built — probing past the surface request — transfers either way.

Q3. I have no professional experience with Agile, Scrum, or Kanban. Can I still complete FIRSTS R21-R23?

A: Yes. These FIRSTS are about building awareness and vocabulary now, so you're not starting from zero when you do encounter these methodologies professionally. Reflect on any adjacent experience — even a flexible personal project counts as a starting point.

Q4. What if escalating something feels like getting someone in trouble?

A: Appropriate escalation is a normal, responsible project management action, not a sign of failure or an attempt to blame someone. A clear, specific escalation protects the project — that reframing is exactly what FIRST R25 is about.

Q5. What if my project doesn't have a formal budget?

A: Even an informal project has resources with real value — your own time, a friend's help, a small amount of money. FIRST R18 applies the same tracking discipline at whatever scale is genuinely relevant to your project.

Q6. Do I need special software to complete FIRST R20 (Project Management Tool Used)?

A: No — many tools (Trello, Asana, and others) offer free tiers sufficient for a personal or small project. The goal is consolidating your planning into one system, not adopting expensive enterprise software.